

National Entrepreneurship Challenge (NEC)

E-Cell, IIT Bombay

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Team: Titan - Fintech & Micro-Commerce

My Motivation

My family runs a small hardware shop in Vadodara. Over the years, I watched my father get repeatedly turned down for small working-capital loans by traditional banks simply because he didn't have audited balance sheets, even though his daily UPI transaction logs showed a steady, reliable cash flow. Millions of micro-merchants face this exact credit bottleneck daily.

This disparity motivated me to combine data science with credit risk modeling. By building alternative scoring engines that analyze UPI velocity, inventory turnover, and supplier repayment habits, we can unlock fair working capital for small merchants. Fintech should empower small businesses, not just serve corporate entities.

My Expectations from E-Cell

Fintech is heavily regulated by RBI guidelines, and operating in lending/credit requires extreme care regarding data privacy and legal compliance. I expect E-Cell to provide access to legal experts and fintech mentors who understand NBFC partnerships.

Through the NEC platform, I want to pressure-test our underwriting algorithms, learn how digital lending partnerships are structured with licensed banks, and develop a clear strategy for building trust with neighborhood store owners.